



Central Coast Regional Water Quality Control Board

October 4, 2024

Sent Via Electronic Mail

Pedro Henderson
Assistant Hospital Administrator –
Department of State Hospitals - Atascadero
California Department of State Hospitals
10333 El Camino Real
Atascadero, CA 93422
e-mail: pedro.henderson@dsh.ca.gov

Dear Pedro Henderson:

**DEPARTMENT OF STATE HOSPITALS - ATASCADERO, 10333 EL CAMINO REAL,
ATASCADERO, SAN LUIS OBISPO COUNTY:**

- **REVISED NOTICE OF APPLICABILITY FOR ENROLLMENT IN ORDER R3-2020-0020, GENERAL WASTE DISCHARGE REQUIREMENTS FOR DISCHARGES FROM DOMESTIC WASTEWATER SYSTEMS WITH FLOWS GREATER THAN 100,000 GALLONS PER DAY;**
- **TRANSMITTAL OF REVISED MONITORING AND REPORTING PROGRAM R3-2024-0057**

California Department of State Hospitals is regulated by the Central Coast Regional Water Quality Control Board (Central Coast Water Board) through enrollment in *General Waste Discharge Requirements Order R3-2020-0020 for Discharges from Domestic Wastewater Systems with Flows Greater than 100,000 Gallons per Day* (General Permit).

This letter serves as a **revised** notice of applicability for enrollment in the General Permit. This letter includes: wastewater system operation summary, specific requirements, and limitations (Attachment 1); figures (Attachment 2); and California Department of State Hospital's monitoring and reporting program requirements (Attachment 3). Please review these documents as requirements have changed.

The revised notice of applicability includes minor revisions and the following key revisions:

1. Removal of interim limits since the interim limit compliance period of 24 months has lapsed.

JANE GRAY, CHAIR | RYAN E. LODGE, EXECUTIVE OFFICER

2. The biosolids/sludge production and handling information in Table 3 of Attachment 1 has been modified to reflect updated biosolids handling practices due to the discontinued use of sludge drying beds.
3. The groundwater Total Nitrogen limit in Table 7 of Attachment 1 has been modified from 10 mg/L to 2.3 mg/L to be consistent with the Water Quality Control Plan for the Central Coastal Basin (Basin Plan).
4. Operator information in Table 2 of Attachment 1 has been updated to reflect the current facility operator.

The revised monitoring and reporting requirements include minor and the following key revisions:

1. Requirement for an Annual Time Schedule Compliance Plan Progress Report, including a progress update on eliminating the salt-adding water softening system, fixing critical collection system problems, ensuring backup power availability, and providing a status update on the proposed consolidation with the City of Atascadero wastewater treatment facility.
2. Requirement for an Updated Operations and Maintenance Manual with revised Sludge Management Plan.

California Department of State Hospitals must comply with the following:

1. **General Permit** – California Department of State Hospitals must comply with all conditions and requirements of the General Permit. As described in the General Permit, ongoing operation, maintenance, monitoring, and reporting are required. A copy of the General Permit can be found electronically at the following link:

https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/centralcoast/board_decisions/adopted_orders/2020/r32020_0020.pdf

2. **Monitoring and Reporting Program** – California Department of State Hospitals must **immediately** comply with the requirements of the revised monitoring and reporting program enclosed with this letter (monitoring and reporting program R3-2024-0057, Attachment 3). California Department of State Hospitals must submit quarterly and annual monitoring reports to the Central Coast Water Board. California Department of State Hospitals is also required to comply with annual volumetric reporting requirements¹ established by the State Water Resources Control Board (State Water Board), due annually to the GeoTracker database on April 30th.

Quarterly monitoring reports and annual reports must be provided electronically in searchable PDF with the Central Coast Water Board's current transmittal sheet found at the link below as the cover page. The transmittal sheet must be signed.

https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/centralcoast/water_issues/programs/wastewater_permitting/docs/transmittal_sheet.pdf

¹ See: [Volumetric Annual Reporting | California State Water Resources Control Board](#)

The transmittal sheet describes who can sign reports. To authorize someone to sign and submit reports on your behalf, you must submit the “designation of duly authorized representatives form” found at the link below to the Central Coast Water Board.

https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/centralcoast/water_issues/programs/wastewater_permitting/

All annual reports must be formatted and completed as specified in the annual report template found at the following link:

https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/centralcoast/board_decisions/adopted_orders/2020/wdr_annual_report_format.pdf

California Department of State Hospitals must submit all reports/documents and laboratory data (using the transmittal sheet as the cover page) to the publicly accessible State Water Board’s GeoTracker^{2,3} database with applicable Electronic Submittal of Information (ESI) requirements under the Wastewater System – specific global identification number **WDR100027049** over the internet at:

<https://geotracker.waterboards.ca.gov/esi/login.asp>

The attached monitoring and reporting program outlines the GeoTracker electronic reporting requirements. The Central Coast Water Board may request submittal of some documents on paper, particularly drawings or maps that require a large size to be readable, or in other electronic formats where evaluation of data is required.

3. **Fees** – California Department of State Hospitals must pay an annual fee to maintain coverage in the General Permit. Annual fees are determined by the State Water Board’s fee program and cover the state fiscal year of July 1 through June 30. Your current annual fee is \$28,205. California Department of State Hospitals Wastewater System is currently assigned a threat and complexity rating of 2B. A copy of the current state fee schedule is available electronically at the following link:

https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/resources/fees/water_quality/#wdr

² Information for first-time GeoTracker users is available at:

https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/ust/electronic_submittal/

³ Additional information available at: <http://geotracker.waterboards.ca.gov/>

- 4. Notification** – The Central Coast Water Board was notified of California Department of State Hospitals enrollment at a regularly scheduled public meeting on May 28-29, 2022. Details about that meeting are available on our website at:

https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/centralcoast/board_info/agendas/

- 5. Future Discharge Modifications** – Pursuant to California Water Code section 13260, California Department of State Hospitals must inform the Central Coast Water Board at least 120 days prior to modifying your discharge. If there are any significant changes in either treatment or disposal methodologies, or the volume or character of the treated wastewater, California Department of State Hospitals must notify the Central Coast Water Board immediately of such changes.

Attachment 1 contains the Central Coast Water Board's understanding of the Wastewater System located at 10333 El Camino Real, Atascadero, CA, 93422. Please review Attachment 1 to determine if the description is representative of your current system. Pursuant to California Water Code section 13267, California Department of State Hospitals must notify the Central Coast Water Board if this information is out of date or incorrect. You are required to provide staff with your updated information within **30 days** of issuance of this letter.

- 6. Responsible Party** – California Department of State Hospitals is responsible for the management and disposal of the domestic wastewater in compliance with the conditions of the General Permit. Any noncompliance with this General Permit constitutes a violation of the California Water Code, and subjects California Department of State Hospitals to enforcement action, and termination of enrollment under this General Permit.
- 7. Change in Ownership** - In the event of any change in control or ownership of the property, California Department of State Hospitals must notify the succeeding owner or operator of the existence of this General Permit by letter, a copy of which shall be immediately forwarded to the Central Coast Water Board so that the new owner or operator can be enrolled in the General Permit and California Department of State Hospitals enrollment in the General Permit can be terminated.

If you have any questions, please contact **Rachel Hohn at (805) 542-4789 or by email at Rachel.Hohn@waterboards.ca.gov** or Jennifer Epp at (805) 594-6181 or by email at Jennifer.Epp@waterboards.ca.gov.

Sincerely,

for Ryan E. Lodge
Executive Officer

Attachments

Attachment 1. Wastewater System Operation Summary, Specific Requirements, and Limitations

Attachment 2. Figures

Attachment 3. Monitoring and Reporting Program R3-2024-0057

cc:

Randy Dye, California Department of State Hospitals, randy.dye@dsh.ca.gov

Fred Peemoeller, Frederick.Peemoeller@dsh.ca.gov

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James Bishop, Central Coast Water Board, James.Bishop@Waterboards.ca.gov

WDR Program, GeoTracker RB3-WDR@Waterboards.ca.gov

ECM/CIWQS = CW-206651

GeoTracker = GT- WDR100027049

Rev 3/15/24

ECM Subject Name = Department of State Hospitals - Atascadero NOA for R3-2020-0020

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ATTACHMENT 1
WASTEWATER SYSTEM OPERATION SUMMARY, SPECIFIC REQUIREMENTS,
AND LIMITATIONS

1. Ownership and Wastewater System Information

Ownership and wastewater system information submitted by California Department of State Hospitals to the Central Coast Water Board is shown in Table 1.

Table 1. Ownership and Wastewater System Information

Name	Department of State Hospitals - Atascadero
Physical Address	10333 El Camino Real Atascadero, CA, 93422
Latitude	35°28'36.0"N
Longitude	120°38'18.4"W
Mailing Address	10333 El Camino Real Atascadero, CA, 93422
Owner	California Department of State Hospitals
Operator	California Department of State Hospitals phone: 805-468-2204 e-mail: randy.dye@dsh.ca.gov
Legally Responsible Official	Stephanie Clendenin phone: 805-468-2204 e-mail: randy.dye@dsh.ca.gov
Service Area	Sewer Connections: 1 Domestic (%): 90% Industrial (%): 10%
Permitted Design Flow (gallons per day, gpd)	500,000
Baseline Flow (average flow) in gpd	167,000
Threat to Water Quality	2
Complexity	B
For Internal Use	
Fee Code	58
Fees Received	--
Primary Place Type	Wastewater Treatment Facility
Facility Type	Municipal/Domestic
Facility Waste Type	Domestic Wastewater
Regulatory measure Type	Enrollee - WDR
Reclamation Included	No

EPA Approved Pretreatment Program	No
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2. Wastewater System Operation Summary

Department of State Hospitals - Atascadero wastewater treatment facility (Wastewater System) is a Class II wastewater system. California Department of State Hospitals must staff a Class II chief plant operator for proper operation of the Wastewater System. Operator names, grades, and license numbers are shown in Table 2.

Table 2. Wastewater System Operators

Operator Name	Grade	License Number
Chris Scherle	3	III-35407
FRM-Contractor	Contract Ops.	CO-0068

The Wastewater System is capable of treating a 500,000 gallons per day to a Secondary treatment level. The Wastewater System consists of the treatment technologies and treatment capabilities shown in Table 3.

Table 3. Treatment Technology and Capacity

Headworks/Preliminary Treatment	Grinder followed by Coarse Screen 1" Rack
	Headworks capacity (gpd): 500,000
Primary Treatment	Primary Clarifier
	Primary treatment capacity (gpd): 500,000
Secondary Treatment	Synthetic Media Trickling Filter Followed by Secondary Clarifier
	Secondary treatment capacity (gpd): 500,000
Tertiary Treatment	N/A
	Tertiary treatment capacity (gpd): N/A
Disinfection	N/A
	Disinfection Capacity (gpd): N/A
Wastewater Disposal Method	Percolation Pond
	Disposal capacity (gpd): 500,000
Biosolids/Sludge Production and Handling	Scum pit is backfilled from anaerobic digester, and vacuumed and hauled off weekly. Quarterly, sludge is hauled directly from the digester. Historically, sludge was dried in on-site sludge drying beds and then the dried biosolids were disced into fields located within Atascadero State Hospital Property. Because the drying beds are unlined, use of the drying beds is no longer allowed. Additionally, because disposal of biosolids to land is inconsistent with Part 503 of the Federal Code of

Non-Potable Recycled Water	Regulations for biosolids disposal, this practice is no longer allowed.	
	Annual production of biosolids: Approx. 6 tons	
	Biosolids/sludge are hauled offsite by Amerigard, LLC	
	Non-potable recycled water produced onsite:	No, wastewater system does NOT produce non-potable recycled water
	Recycled water usage areas:	N/A
	Enrolled in WQ 2016-0068-DDW:	No, this wastewater system is NOT enrolled in WQ 2016-0068-DDW
	Recycled water production volume (gpd):	N/A

3. Wastewater System Specific Requirements and Limitations

California Department of State Hospitals must operate the Wastewater System in accordance with the General Permit and this notice of applicability. California Department of State Hospitals must comply with the wastewater specific limitations specified in Table 4 through Table 7.

Flow limitations are shown in Table 4. **Effluent limitations are shown in Table 5 and Table 6.**

A. Flow Limitations:

Table 4. Flow Limitations

Constituent	Units	Limit	Point of Compliance
Design Flow (peak)	Gallons per day	500,000	Influent

B. Effluent Limitations:

Table 5. Effluent Limitations: Trickling Filters

Constituent	Units	30-Day Average	7-Day Average	Sample Maximum
Effluent Flow (peak)	Gallons per day	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	
Biochemical Oxygen Demand, 5-Day	mg/L	30	45	Not Applicable

Constituent	Units	30-Day Average	7-Day Average	Sample Maximum
Total Suspended Solids	mg/L	30	45	Not Applicable
Settleable Solids	mL/L	0.3	Not Applicable	0.5
pH	Not Applicable	Between 6.5 and 8.4	Not Applicable	Not Applicable

Table 6. Effluent limitations for Designated Groundwater Basins - *Paso Robles Area Atascadero*

Constituents	Units	25-Month Rolling Median
Total Dissolved Solids	mg/L ^[1]	550
Chloride	mg/L	70
Sodium	mg/L	65
Sulfate	mg/L	85
Boron	mg/L	0.3
Total Nitrogen	mg/L	10

[1] mg/L denotes milligrams per liter

C. Groundwater Limitations:

Through groundwater monitoring, California Department of State Hospitals must demonstrate that the discharge does not cause underlying groundwater to exceed the water quality objectives set forth in the Basin Plan including the limitations listed in Table 7.

Table 7. Groundwater Limitations for Designated Groundwater Basins - *Paso Robles Area Atascadero*

Constituents	Units	25-Month Rolling Median
Total Dissolved Solids	mg/L ^[1]	550
Chloride	mg/L	70
Sodium	mg/L	65
Sulfate	mg/L	85
Boron	mg/L	0.3
Total Nitrogen	mg/L	2.3

[1] mg/L denotes milligrams per liter

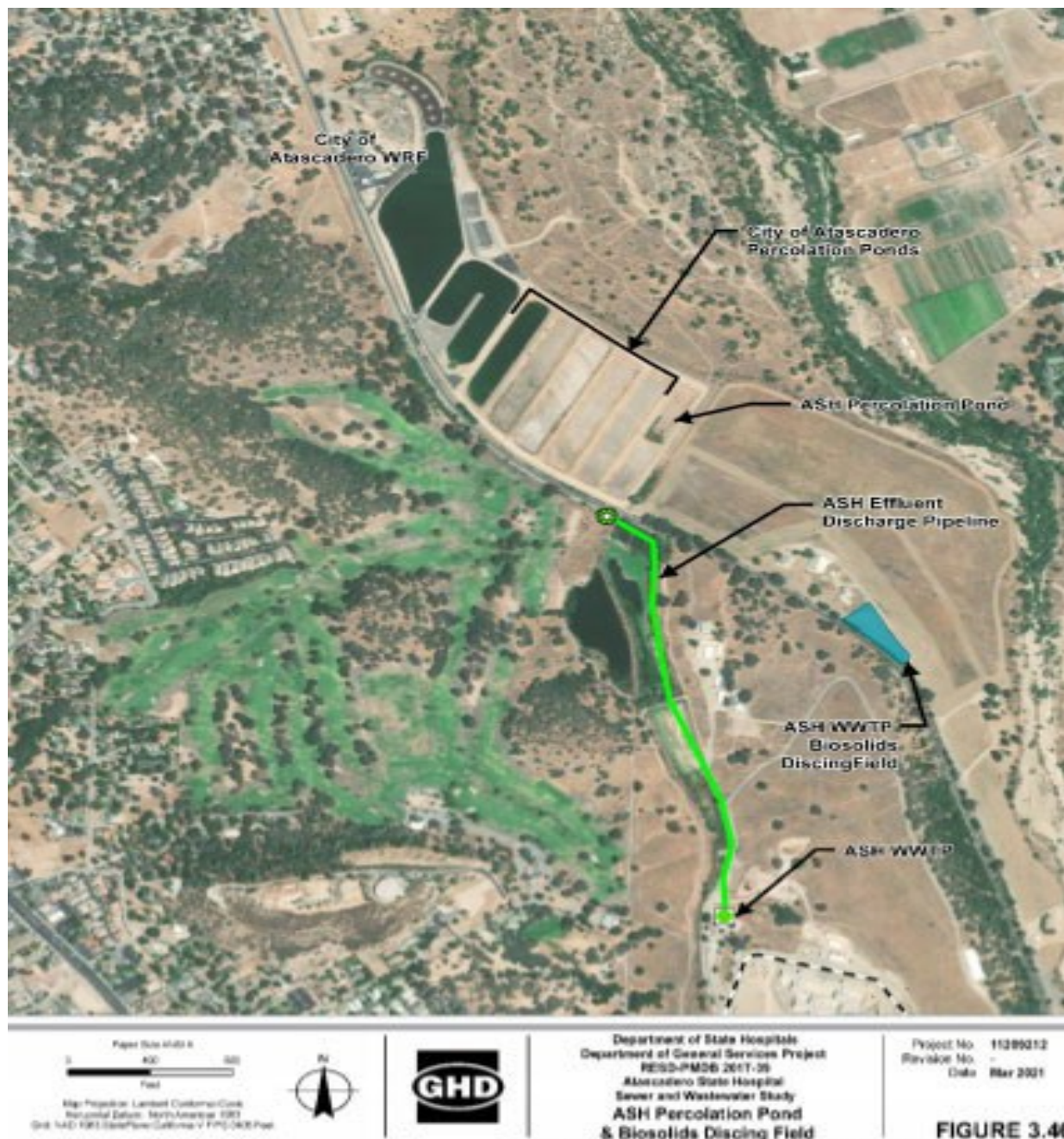
**ATTACHMENT 2
FIGURES**

Figure 1. Disposal Location Map. Note that dicing biosolids into fields, as shown on the figure above, is no longer allowed.



Figure 2. Site Map

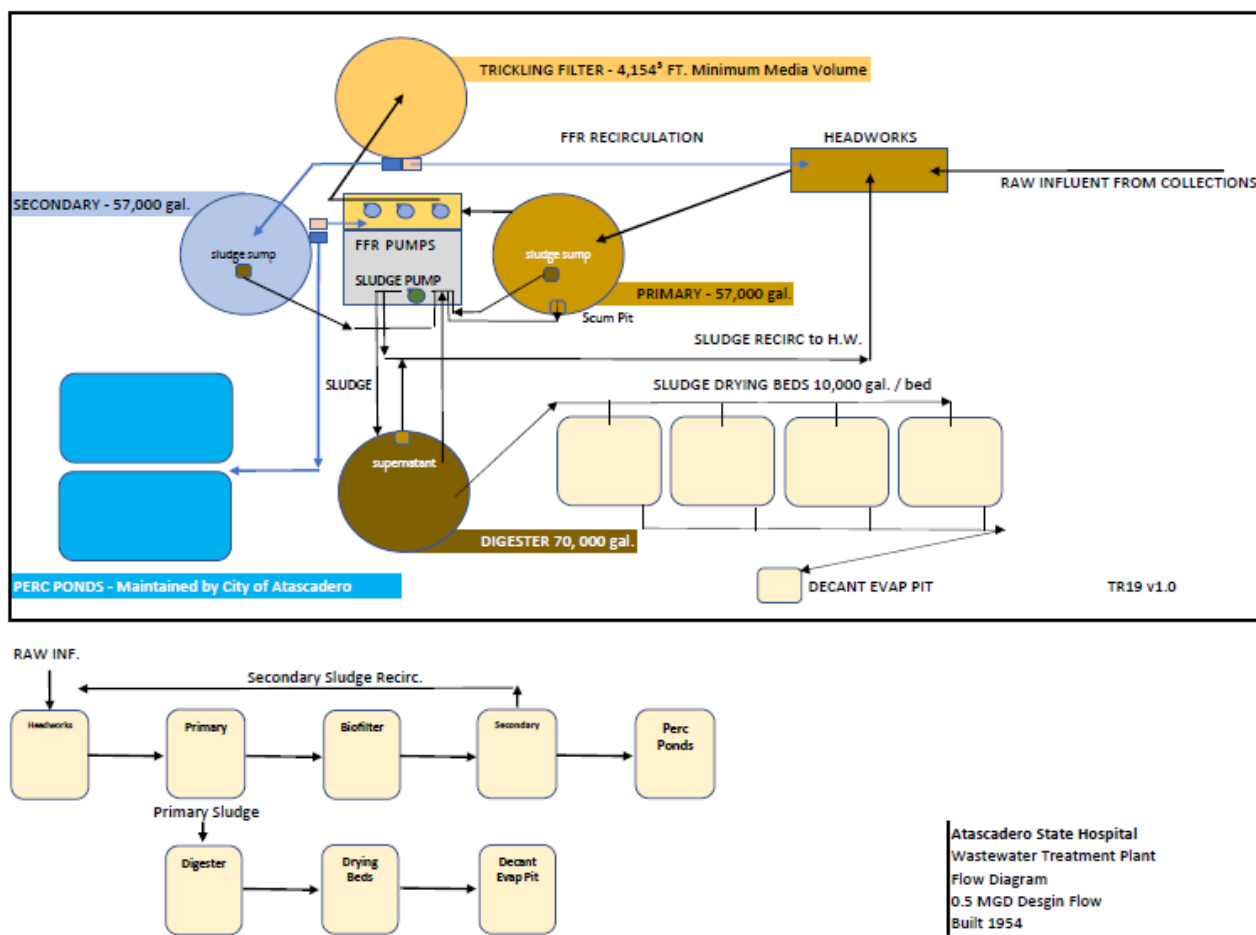


Figure 3. Process Flow Diagram

**ATTACHMENT 3
MONITORING AND REPORTING PROGRAM**

CENTRAL COAST REGIONAL WATER QUALITY CONTROL BOARD

**MONITORING AND REPORTING PROGRAM R3-2024-0057
Revised October 4, 2024**

**MODIFICATION OF MONITORING AND REPORTING PROGRAM R3-2020-0020
FOR
DEPARTMENT OF STATE HOSPITALS – ATASCADERO WASTEWATER SYSTEMS
ATASCADERO, SAN LUIS OBISPO COUNTY**

This Monitoring and Reporting Program contains monitoring and reporting requirements for California Department of State Hospitals – Atascadero wastewater treatment facility (Wastewater System) enrolled in *General Waste Discharge Requirements Order R3-2020-0020 for Discharges from Domestic Wastewater Systems with Flows Greater than 100,000 Gallons per Day* (General Permit).

California Department of State Hospitals owns and operates the Wastewater System that is subject to the General Permit and notice of applicability.

The State Water Resources Control Board (State Water Board) and Regional Water Quality Control Boards are transitioning to the use of the publicly accessible State Water Board's GeoTracker database for the tracking of environmental and regulatory data for sites that operate under waste discharge requirements. The monitoring and reporting program directs California Department of State Hospitals to submit reports (both technical and monitoring reports) and analytical data electronically to the State Water Board's GeoTracker database (see monitoring and reporting program section 8).

1. SAMPLING AND ANALYSIS

California Department of State Hospitals must collect representative samples in accordance with the most recently approved sampling and analysis plan contained in the Operations and Maintenance Manual and validate analytical results prior to submittal to the Central Coast Regional Water Quality Control Board (Central Coast Water Board). All samples (e.g., wastewater, groundwater, soil, sludge) must be representative of the volume and nature of the discharge or matrix of materials sampled.

All samples must be collected by a qualified person, trained in proper procedures for collecting the samples. The name of the sampler, sample type (grab or composite), time, date, location, bottle/container type, and any preservative used for each sample must be recorded on the sample chain of custody form. The chain of custody form must

also contain all custody information including date, time, and to whom samples were relinquished. If composite samples are collected, the basis for sampling (time or flow weighted) must be included in the sampling and analysis plan contained in the Operations and Maintenance Manual for Central Coast Water Board review and approval.

A. Sampling Schedule

Unless otherwise specified below, sampling must be performed in accordance with Table 1.

Table 1. Sampling Schedule

Monitoring Period	Sample Collection Time
Daily	Each day of the week
Quarterly	January, April, July, and October
Semiannually	April and October
Annually	October

Field test instruments (such as those used to test pH, dissolved oxygen, and electrical conductivity) may be used if they are used by a State Water Board Environmental Laboratory Accreditation Program accredited laboratory, or:

1. The user is trained in proper use and maintenance of the instruments;
2. The instruments are field calibrated prior to monitoring events at the frequency recommended by the manufacturer;
3. Instruments are serviced and/or calibrated by the manufacturer at the recommended frequency; and
4. Field calibration reports are maintained and available for at least three years.

B. Monitoring Location Descriptions

All samples including influent samples (IS), effluent samples (ES), and groundwater monitoring wells (MW) must be collected at the locations described in Table 2 and shown in Figure 1. These locations must be consistent with the Central Coast Water Board approved sampling and analysis plan. **California Department of State Hospitals must upload the GeoTracker field point information for each sampling location in the GeoTracker database once, prior to uploading laboratory data (see Table 9).**

Table 2. Sample Identification Details

GeoTracker Field Point Class	GeoTracker Field Point Name (Sample ID)	GeoTracker Field Point Description
Influent Sample	IS-1	Raw wastewater sample collected at the headworks, upstream of sludge recirculation
Effluent Sample	ES-1	Treated wastewater sample collected downstream from the secondary clarifier
Water Supply Well	WSW-1 ^[1]	Water from the well that supplies water to Atascadero State Hospital

^[1] Water supply sample data should be included in the annual report but does not need to be uploaded to GeoTracker if the Central Coast Water Board approves submittal of a Well Identification Number pursuant to the Water Supply Monitoring section below.

2. WATER SUPPLY MONITORING

Representative samples of California Department of State Hospital's raw water supply (sampled before use or treatment) must be collected and analyzed, at a minimum, for constituents specified in Table 3.

In lieu of the required water supply sampling, California Department of State Hospitals may request Central Coast Water Board approval to submit a Well Identification Number and the reporting year's consumer confidence report (annual water quality report or drinking water quality report), as required by the State Water Board Division of Drinking Water and/or county, provided, at a minimum, all of the required constituents are sampled at the frequency specified in Table 3. California Department of State Hospitals must report the results of any constituent monitored more frequently than is required by the monitoring program shown in Table 3. California Department of State Hospitals must also report detectable concentrations (above the reporting limit) for any other constituent that has a published maximum contaminant level (MCL).

California Department of State Hospitals must evaluate and provide a tabular summary of the water supply data with the annual monitoring report.

Table 3. Water Supply Monitoring

Constituent	Units^[1]	Sample Type	Sampling Frequency
Nitrate (as N)	mg/L	Grab	Annually
Total Dissolved Solids	mg/L	Grab	Annually
Chloride	mg/L	Grab	Annually

Constituent	Units ^[1]	Sample Type	Sampling Frequency
Sodium	mg/L	Grab	Annually
Sulfate	mg/L	Grab	Annually
Boron	mg/L	Grab	Annually
Carbonate	mg/L	Grab	Annually
Bicarbonate	mg/L	Grab	Annually
Calcium	mg/L	Grab	Annually
Potassium	mg/L	Grab	Annually
Magnesium	mg/L	Grab	Annually

[1] mg/L denotes milligrams per liter

3. INFLUENT AND EFFLUENT MONITORING

A. Influent and Effluent Flow Monitoring

California Department of State Hospitals must monitor and report flow in gallons per day, as described in Table 4, with each monitoring report. See monitoring and reporting program section 6 for supplemental volumetric annual reporting requirements established by the State Water Board.

Table 4. Influent and Effluent Flow Monitoring

	INFLUENT	INFLUENT	EFFLUENT	EFFLUENT
Parameter	Sample Type	Sampling Frequency	Sample Type	Sampling Frequency
Daily Flow ^[2]	Metered	Daily	Metered/Estimated ^[1]	Daily
Maximum (Peak) Daily Flow	Metered	Monthly	Metered/Estimated ^[1]	Monthly
Mean Daily Flow	Calculated	Monthly	Calculated	Monthly

[1] If the flow is estimated, California Department of State Hospitals is required to provide an explanation (e.g., no meter- estimated using pump operations including rate and time) with each monitoring report.

[2] The General Permit notice of applicability specifies the Wastewater System's permitted flow. In the monitoring reports, California Department of State Hospitals must evaluate and provide a comparison of monitored flow to the permitted flow.

Representative samples of California Department of State Hospital's influent (raw wastewater) into the Wastewater System and effluent (treated wastewater) discharged to land must be collected and analyzed in accordance with the treatment technology-based monitoring requirements (including sample type and frequency) summarized in the tables below. See Figure 1 for the location of samples and GeoTracker field points.

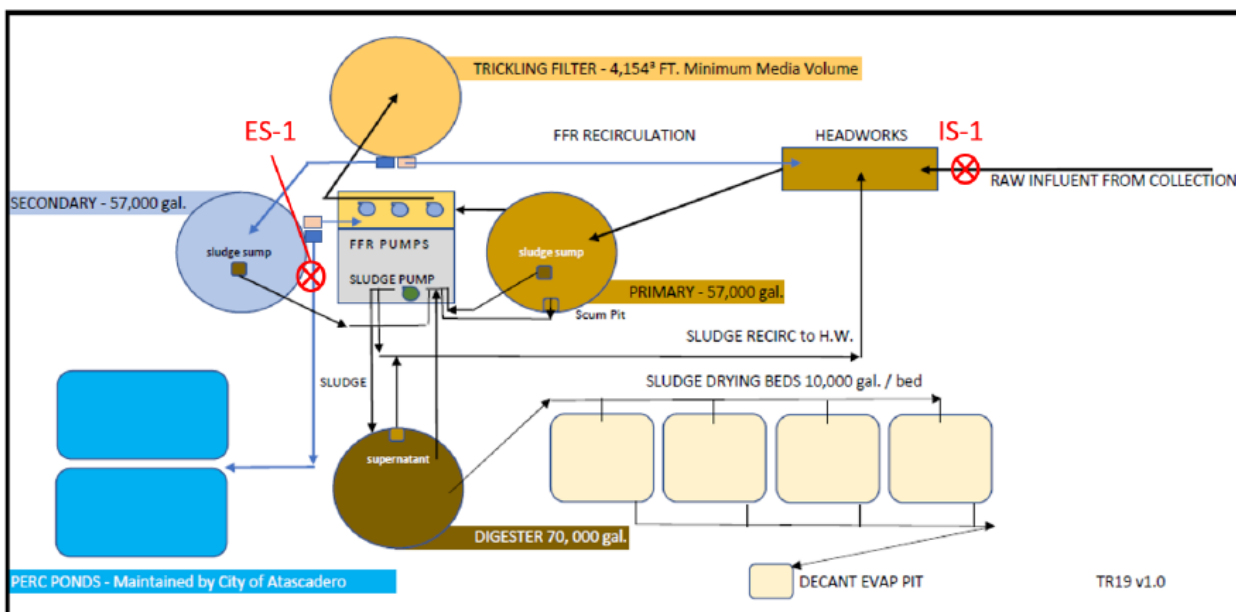


Figure 1. Process Flow Diagram and Sample Locations Referenced in Table 2

- i. **Required Pond Monitoring** – All wastewater treatment and treated wastewater storage/disposal ponds (lined and unlined) must be monitored as specified in Table 5. Sampling for pH and dissolved oxygen must be a grab sample taken from 1 foot below pond surface.

Observations do not need to be reported in the monitoring reports unless a violation, significant change, or treatment issue is observed. Photos of the pond(s) verifying the observations must be collected annually and included in the annual report, with the date and location of the photo clearly marked. Observations must be noted in a logbook or database and made available to the Central Coast Water Board upon request. Any problems must be promptly corrected and recorded.

Table 5. Wastewater Treatment/Storage/Disposal Pond Monitoring

Parameter/ Constituent	Units	Sample Type	Sampling/Monitoring Frequency
Freeboard	0.1 feet	Measured	Weekly
pH	pH Units	Grab	Weekly
Dissolved Oxygen (in pond)	mg/L	Grab	Monthly
Odors	Not applicable	Observation	Weekly
Berm condition	Not Applicable	Observation	Monthly
Sludge Depth	0.1 feet	Measured	Annually
Precipitation	inches/day and date	Measured ^[1]	Each precipitation event ^[2]

[1] California Department of State Hospitals may use a rain gauge or use a National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration, United States Geological Survey, or California Irrigation Management Information System weather station, such as <http://scacis.rcc-acis.org/>.

[2] A precipitation event is one producing precipitation of ½ inch or more.

D. Trickling Filter System Monitoring

- i. **Influent and Effluent Monitoring** – At a minimum, influent and effluent constituent monitoring for the trickling filter system must be monitored as specified in Table 6.

Table 6. Influent and Effluent Monitoring for Trickling Filter Systems

		INFLUENT (IS-1)	INFLUENT (IS-1)	EFFLUENT (ES-1)	EFFLUENT (ES-1)
Parameter/ Constituent	Units	Sample Type	Sampling Frequency	Sample Type	Sampling Frequency
pH	units	Grab	Weekly	Grab	Weekly
Biochemical Oxygen Demand, 5-Day	mg/L	24-hour composite	Quarterly	Grab	Monthly
Total Suspended Solids	mg/L	24-hour composite	Quarterly	Grab	Monthly
Settleable Solids	ml/L	Not Required	Not Required	Grab	Weekly
Total Nitrogen ^[2]	mg/L	Calculated	Quarterly	Calculated	Monthly

		INFLUENT (IS-1)	INFLUENT (IS-1)	EFFLUENT (ES-1)	EFFLUENT (ES-1)
Parameter/ Constituent	Units	Sample Type	Sampling Frequency	Sample Type	Sampling Frequency
Nitrate (as N) + Nitrite (as N) or separate species	mg/L	24-hour composite	Quarterly	Grab	Monthly
Total Kjeldahl Nitrogen (as N)	mg/L	24-hour composite	Quarterly	Grab	Monthly
Ammonia (as N)	mg/L	24-hour composite	Quarterly	Grab	Monthly
Total Dissolved Solids	mg/L	24-hour composite	Quarterly	Grab	Monthly
Chloride	mg/L	24-hour composite	Quarterly	Grab	Monthly
Sodium	mg/L	24-hour composite	Quarterly	Grab	Monthly
Sulfate	mg/L	24-hour composite	Quarterly	Grab	Monthly
Boron	mg/L	Not Required	Not Required	Grab	Monthly
Carbonate	mg/L	Not Required	Not Required	Grab	Semiannually
Bicarbonate	mg/L	Not Required	Not Required	Grab	Semiannually
Calcium	mg/L	Not Required	Not Required	Grab	Semiannually
Potassium	mg/L	Not Required	Not Required	Grab	Semiannually
Magnesium	mg/L	Not Required	Not Required	Grab	Semiannually

[1] Total nitrogen is the sum of total inorganic nitrogen (nitrate + nitrite + ammonium + ammonia) and organic nitrogen.

4. WASTEWATER DISPOSAL MONITORING

California Department of State Hospitals must monitor all wastewater disposal areas (e.g., land application areas, percolation ponds) when wastewater and/or supplemental irrigation water is applied. Inspections (observations) must be conducted as described in Table 7. Notations must be made in a bound logbook and problems must be promptly corrected and recorded. A log of these inspections must be maintained onsite and made available to Central Coast Water Board upon request. Observations do not need to be reported in the monitoring reports unless a violation of permit conditions or issues are observed. If violations are observed, planned and implemented mitigation measures to address the violations must be reported.

California Department of State Hospitals must evaluate and summarize wastewater disposal application rates, loading rates (pounds/acre/day), violations found during the inspections, with each monitoring report.

If wastewater and/or supplemental irrigation water is not discharged to land during a reporting period, the monitoring report must still be submitted and indicate that there was no discharge during the reporting period.

Table 7. Wastewater Disposal Monitoring

Constituent	Units	Sample Type	Monitoring Frequency
Supplemental Irrigation	Gallons per day	Metered/Estimated ^[1]	Daily
Local Precipitation	Inches/day	Weather Station ^[2]	Each precipitation event
Acreage Applied ^[3]	Acres	Measured	Daily
Application Rate	Gallons per day	Metered/Estimated ^[1]	Daily
Average Monthly Biochemical Oxygen Demand, 5-Day (BOD) Applied ^[4] ^[5]	lbs/acre/day	Calculated	Monthly
Total Nitrogen Applied ^[4] ^[5]	lbs/acre/day	Calculated	Monthly
Salts Applied ^[4] ^[5] (total dissolved solids, sodium, chloride, sulfate, boron)	lbs/acre/day	Calculated	Monthly
Soil Erosion Evidence	Not Applicable	Observation	Monthly
Containment Berm Condition	Not Applicable	Observation	Monthly
Soil Saturation/Ponding	Not Applicable	Observation	Monthly
Nuisance Odors/Vectors	Not Applicable	Observation	Monthly
Discharge Offsite	Not Applicable	Observation	Monthly

[1] Requires meter reading, a pump run time meter, or other approved method. If the flow is estimated, California Department of State Hospitals is required to provide an explanation (e.g., no meter- estimated using pump operations including rate and time) with each monitoring report.

[2] California Department of State Hospitals must have a rain gauge or use a NOAA or USGS rain station, such as <http://scacis.rcc-acis.org/>.

[3] Acreage applied denotes the acreage to which wastewater is applied.

[4] The total nitrogen, salts, and BOD applied loading rates must be calculated from wastewater flow volumes, applied acreage, and concentrations reported in effluent analytical testing as follows:

Total Nitrogen/Salts/BOD Applied (pounds/acre/ day) =

$$\frac{X \text{ [mg/L]} \times Q \text{ [million gallons per day]} \times 8.34 \text{ [(conversion from mg/L to pounds/million gallons per day)]}}{\text{Acreage Applied [acres]}}$$

Where X = Total nitrogen, salts, or BOD concentration

Where Q = Application Rate (often effluent flow rate)

[5] Frequencies of analytical testing are defined in the influent and effluent monitoring tables (Table 4, Table 5, Table 6).

5. SLUDGE/BIOSOLIDS DISPOSAL MONITORING

California Department of State Hospitals must report the handling and disposal of all sludge/biosolids generated at the Wastewater System. Records must include the date removed from the Wastewater System, name/contact information for the hauling company, the type and volume of waste transported, the disposal facility name and address, and copies of analytical data required by the entity accepting the waste. These records must be submitted as part of the annual monitoring report.

California Department of State Hospitals must also monitor sludge/biosolids consistent with a Central Coast Water Board approved sludge management plan and in accordance with the requirements specified by the receiving party, including a regulated landfill and/or regulated composting facility.

If sludge/biosolids are not removed during the year, California Department of State Hospitals must explain the absence of this monitoring in the annual report.

6. REPORTING REQUIREMENTS

A. Quarterly and Annual Monitoring Reports

Quarterly and annual monitoring reports are due as described in Table 8.

Table 8. Quarterly and Annual Monitoring Reporting

Report	Monitoring Period	Report Due Date
First Quarter Monitoring Report	January 1 to March 31	May 1
Second Quarter Monitoring Report	April 1 to June 30	August 1
Third Quarter Monitoring Report	July 1 to September 30	November 1
Fourth Quarter Monitoring Report	October 1 to December 31	February 1
Annual Report	January 1 to December 31	March 1
State Water Board Volumetric Annual Reporting	January 1 to December 31	April 30

1. **Quarterly Monitoring Reporting** – At a minimum, the quarterly reports must include:
 - i. Results of all required monitoring in tabular format.
 - ii. The results of any pollutant or parameter monitored more frequently than is required by this monitoring program. Values obtained through additional monitoring must be used in calculations as appropriate.
 - iii. A comparison of monitoring data to the discharge specifications, applicable effluent limitations, disclosure of any violations of the notice of applicability and/or General Permit, and an explanation of any violation of those requirements. **California Department of State Hospitals must calculate 7-day averages, 30-day averages and 25-month rolling medians for select analytes when comparing monitoring data to applicable effluent limitations specified in the General Permit.** Data must be presented in tabular format.
 - iv. Copies of laboratory analytical report(s) and chain of custody form(s).
 - v. An updated hydrogeologic conceptual site model with the groundwater monitoring reporting requirements based on new information generated from the monitoring well boring logs, groundwater elevation data, and water quality data.
 - vi. Copies of groundwater monitoring well field sheets with purge methods and data.
2. **Annual Reporting** – California Department of State Hospitals must submit annual reports in compliance with Standard Provisions 2013¹, (and any updates to the Standard Provisions) Section C, General Reporting Requirements, Item 16 using the most recent annual report template provided by Central Coast Water Board.

The current annual report template can be found here:

https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/centralcoast/board_decisions/adopted_orders/2020/wdr_annual_report_format.pdf

California Department of State Hospitals must include the following operator information with the annual report:

¹ See Attachment E, Standard Provisions, 2013:
https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/centralcoast/board_decisions/docs/wdr_standard_provisions_2013.pdf

- i. The name, grade, and license number for the wastewater operator responsible for operation, maintenance, and system monitoring, and all operator personnel.
 - ii. A copy of the current Office of Operator Certification Wastewater Treatment Plant Classification Form.
 - iii. A copy of the current Office of Operator Certification Chief Plant Operator Acknowledgement Form.
 - iv. If a contract operator is used, a copy of the contract operator certificate from the Office of Operator Certification.
3. **State Water Board Volumetric Annual Reporting** – California Department of State Hospitals must electronically certify and submit a summary of the monthly influent and effluent flow volume by April 30th of each calendar year via the State Water Board's Internet GeoTracker database.²

The following information is required:

- v. Monthly volume of wastewater collected and treated by the wastewater treatment plant (i.e. total monthly influent volume).
- vi. Monthly volume of wastewater treated, specifying level of treatment, including treated wastewater discharged.
- vii. If applicable, monthly volume of recycled water distributed, and annual volume of treated wastewater distributed for beneficial use in compliance with California Code of Regulations, title 22 use categories.

Additional information about volumetric annual reporting of wastewater and recycled water and the Recycled Water Policy is available at the Recycled Water Policy Volumetric Annual Reporting Website³.

7. NON-COMPLIANCE REPORTING:

California Department of State Hospitals must notify and report to Central Coast Water Board noncompliance of limits related to pond freeboard, flow rate, bypass or overflow, the conditionally accepted title 22 Engineering Report requirements, delivery of off-specification recycled water, and wastewater containment failure, pursuant to General Permit section VI.C.2.

² See: <https://geotracker.waterboards.ca.gov/>

³ See: [Volumetric Annual Reporting | California State Water Resources Control Board](#)

8. ELECTRONIC GEOTRACKER SUBMITTAL

All monitoring reports must be provided electronically in a searchable PDF format, with the Central Coast Water Board's current transmittal sheet found at the link below as the cover page. The transmittal sheet must be signed.

https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/centralcoast/water_issues/programs/wastewater_permiitting/docs/transmittal_sheet.pdf

The transmittal sheet describes who can sign reports. To authorize someone to sign and submit reports on your behalf, you must submit the "designation of duly authorized representatives form" found at the link below to the Central Coast Water Board.

https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/centralcoast/water_issues/programs/wastewater_permiitting/

California Department of State Hospitals must submit all reports/documents and laboratory analytical data to the State Water Board's GeoTracker^{4,5} database consistent with applicable Electronic Submittal of Information (ESI) requirements under the Wastewater System-specific global identification number **WDR100027049** at:

<https://geotracker.waterboards.ca.gov/esi/login>

For general questions, please contact the GeoTracker Help Desk at:

Geotracker@waterboards.ca.gov.

Table 9 summarizes all the GeoTracker electronic reporting requirements. Central Coast Water Board may request submittal of some documents on paper, particularly drawings or maps that require a large size to be readable, or in other electronic formats where evaluation of data is required.

Table 9. GeoTracker Electronic Submittal Information Data Requirements

Electronic Submittal	Description of Action	Action	Frequency
Reports and Documents	Complete copy of all documents including monitoring reports (in searchable PDF format) and any other associated documents related to the Wastewater System.	Upload directly to GeoTracker all monitoring reports (in searchable PDF format) and any other associated documents.	On or before the due dates required by this General Permit and for other documents when required by the Central Coast Water Board.

⁴ Information for first-time GeoTracker users is available at:

https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/ust/electronic_submittal/docs/beginnerguide2.pdf

⁵ Additional information available at:

<https://geotracker.waterboards.ca.gov/>

Electronic Submittal	Description of Action	Action	Frequency
Laboratory Data	All analytical data (including geochemical data) in electronic deliverable format (EDF). This includes all water, soil, and vapor samples collected when monitoring a discharge.	Upload, or direct your California ELAP-accredited laboratory staff to upload, all EDF laboratory data directly to GeoTracker.	On or before the due date of the required monitoring report.
Depth to Groundwater	Monitoring wells must have the depth-to-water information reported. Report data only for wells defined as permanent sampling points.	Upload depth-to-water information to the GeoTracker GEO_WELL file.	On or before the due date of the required monitoring report.
Boring Logs and Well Screen Intervals	Boring logs must be prepared by a registered professional and submitted in PDF format separately (not only as attachments to reports).	Upload boring logs (in searchable PDF format) to GeoTracker GEO_BORE file whenever a new boring is drilled.	Every time a new boring is drilled.
Field Points, Location Data (Geo XY) ^[1]	Name, classify, and identify the location (latitude and longitude) of all sampling points. Monitoring wells must be surveyed, influent and effluent sample locations must be identified on the GeoTracker mapping tool under "non-surveyed data." These data points are required prior to laboratory data uploads.	Upload the location data (surveyed and non-surveyed) to the GeoTracker Geo_XY file.	Every time a permanent monitoring point is established.
Elevation Data (Geo Z) ^[2]	Survey and mark the elevation at the top of groundwater well casings for all permanent groundwater wells. These points are required prior to depth-to-water data uploads.	Upload the survey data to the GeoTracker GEO_Z file.	One-time, for all groundwater monitoring wells.
Geo Map	Site layout, map of facilities, Wastewater System including treatment and disposal area(s).	Upload the Site layout PDF to the GeoTracker site plan file.	Year one and every five years thereafter and when the facilities are modified.

[1] Geo XY required for all wells. New wells must be surveyed. For existing wells, use original well installation survey data. California Department of State Hospitals must also upload sample

locations (e.g., influent and effluent samples) that are not defined as a **permanent monitoring well** and have not been surveyed by a licensed professional.

- [2] Geo Z required for all wells. New wells must be surveyed. For existing wells, use original well installation survey data.

9. TECHNICAL REPORTS

The technical reports are due as described in Table 10.

Table 10. Technical Report Submittal Due Dates

Report	Report Due Date ^[1]
Annual Time Schedule Compliance Plan Progress Report	Annually, every August 31
Updated Operations and Maintenance Manual with revised Sludge and Biosolids Management Plan	January 6, 2025

A. Annual Time Schedule Compliance Plan Progress Report

California Department of State Hospitals must annually submit a Time Schedule Compliance Plan Progress Report every August 31. The annual update must be submitted to GeoTracker and signed by the Chief Plant Operator, the Chief Engineer, and the Chief of Operations for Atascadero State Hospital. At a minimum, the Annual Time Schedule Compliance Plan Progress Report must include:

- i. A status update on Atascadero State Hospital's connection to the City of Atascadero including the following:
 - a. Anticipated timeline of connection to the City of Atascadero.
 - b. Status updates on steps that have been taken to move towards connection including relevant communication with the City of Atascadero.
 - c. Information regarding funding for the project.
- ii. A summary of progress on upgrades to the collection system recommended by GHD in Appendix G of the 2021 Atascadero State Hospital Sewer and Wastewater Study. The summary must include the following:
 - a. A description of upgrades to the collection system that have been completed since the 2021 study.
 - b. Estimated timeline for implementation of each of the upgrades to the collection system recommended by GHD.
 - c. A detailed time schedule of actions and measurable milestones associated with the "interim collection system repairs" recommended by GHD in Appendix G, Table 1 of the study.

- d. Information regarding necessary and acquired funding for each of the upgrades.
- iii. A status update on Atascadero State Hospital's plan to move toward compliance with salts limits. According to the 2021 Atascadero State Hospital Sewer and Wastewater Study by GHD, Atascadero State Hospital's water softening system currently utilizes 20 tons of salt every 3-4 months (page 22). Atascadero State Hospital has been consistently out of compliance with effluent salt limits. The status update must include the following information:
 - a. Comparison of the current effluent quality to the effluent and groundwater limitations in General Permit Tables 3-6.
 - b. Current status and progress on implementation of the chosen technology to achieve compliance.
 - c. Estimated timeline of implementation of the chosen technology.
 - d. An analysis of expected effluent quality once the technology has been implemented in comparison with effluent and groundwater limitations specified in General Permit Tables 3-6.
- iv. A description of the changes implemented at the facility ensure ongoing compliance with the General Permit requirement to have backup power available to the wastewater system to prevent bypasses and discharges.

B. Updated Operations and Maintenance Manual with revised Sludge Management Plan

California Department of State Hospitals must submit an updated Operations and Maintenance Manual that includes a sludge and biosolids management plan that reflects current sludge management practices. The existing Operation and Maintenance Manual still refers to the old drying beds and discing biosolids into California Department of State Hospitals-owned fields. These practices are no longer allowed and should be removed from the manual.

10. LEGAL REQUIREMENTS

The Central Coast Water Board requires California Department of State Hospitals to submit the technical and monitoring reports described in this monitoring and reporting program pursuant to [California Water Code section 13267](#). Failure to submit reports in accordance with the schedules established by the Permit or failure to submit a report of sufficient technical quality to be acceptable to the Central Coast Water Board may subject California Department of State Hospitals to enforcement action pursuant to [California Water Code section 13268](#).

The burden, including costs, of the reports bears a reasonable relationship to their need and the benefits to be obtained. The requirement for the reports is necessary to ensure compliance with the Permit and to protect water quality. California Department of State

October 4, 2024

Hospitals is required to submit this information because it is subject to the Permit and is responsible for the discharge.

California Department of State Hospitals must implement the above monitoring program immediately. The Central Coast Water Board may rescind or modify the monitoring and reporting program at any time. California Department of State Hospitals must not implement any changes to this monitoring and reporting program unless and until a revised monitoring and reporting program is issued by the Central Coast Water Board.

Ordered By:

for Ryan E. Lodge
Executive Officer

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State Hosp\1- Permit\general order R3-2020-0020\NOA MRP\2024
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